

Deleting partitions

The term volume refers to a storage device, such as a hard disk. It may also refer to a portion of the storage on that device since the storage can be divided into chunks. In a procedure known as mounting, the computer makes this storage available via your filesystem. Hard disks, USB drives, DVD-RWs, SD cards, and other media may be mounted. You can read (and sometimes write) files on a disk that is mounted at the time.

A mounted volume is often referred to as a partition, even though the two are not always the same thing. A “partition” is a physical storage region on a single disk drive. When a partition is mounted, it is referred to as a volume since the files on it may be accessed. Volumes may be thought of as labelled, accessible “storefronts” to the functional “back rooms” of partitions and disks.

Using the disk utility, you may see and manage volumes and partitions. Disk utility allows you to see and change the storage volumes on your computer.

Start Disks by opening the Activities overview.

Hard disks, CD/DVD drives, and other physical devices are among the storage devices shown on the left. Select the device you wish to examine by clicking on it.

The right pane displays a visual breakdown of the volumes and partitions available on the chosen device. It also includes a number of tools for managing these volumes.

Be cautious: these utilities have the capability to totally erase the data on your disk.

Most computers have at least one main partition and one swap partition. The swap partition is used for memory management by the operating system and is seldom mounted. Your operating system, programs, settings, and personal data are all stored on the main partition. For security or for convenience, these files may also be spread across several partitions.

One main partition must hold data needed by your computer to start, or boot. Hence, it is also known as a boot partition or boot volume. To check if a volume is bootable, select it and then click the menu button in the toolbar under the partition list. Then, choose Edit Partition... and examine its Flags. A bootable volume may also be found on external media such as USB devices and CDs.

To remove partitions in Ubuntu using Fdisk, follow the procedures described in the sections below.